Social rule – NPC attitudes and social play · SRD 5.2.1

The **Influence** action lets you persuade a creature. The DM first decides whether it is **Willing**, **Hesitant** or **Unwilling**. Only the Hesitant one calls for a **Charisma** check (Deception, Intimidation, Performance, Persuasion) or a **Wisdom** check (Animal Handling).

🎲 Quick summary:

1. Willing: **complies**, no check.
2. Unwilling: **refuses**, no check.
3. Hesitant: **check**, DC **15** or its **Intelligence** (the higher).
4. **Friendly** attitude: advantage; **hostile**: disadvantage.

⚠ Change from 2014

SRD 2024 replaces the old attitude table with the Influence action and three states: Willing / Hesitant / Unwilling.

⚠ Flaw in the rule and fixes Table rule

The SRD doesn't say how to handle a hostile NPC. Fix: the NPC keeps its attitude, but Intimidation may change it.

💡 Narrative option: Table rule

The DM can describe the NPC's tone, gaze and gestures before announcing its reaction.

Step 1 – Describe:

The player says how they address the creature.

Step 2 – State:

The DM chooses: Willing, Unwilling or Hesitant.

Step 3 – Check:

If Hesitant: Charisma (Deception, Intimidation, Performance, Persuasion) or Wisdom (Animal Handling, Beasts and Monstrosities).

Step 4 – DC:

15 or the creature's Intelligence, if higher. Advantage if Friendly, disadvantage if Hostile.

Step 5 – Failure:

Wait 24 hours (or a duration the DM sets) before trying the same approach.

Example: Elora persuades a hesitant guard (DC 15, neutral attitude). She rolls 17: he lets her pass. A failed second attempt bars the same argument until tomorrow.

State / attitude	Effect
Willing	Complies its own way, no check
Unwilling	Refuses, no check
Hesitant	Check, DC 15 or Intelligence
Friendly attitude	Advantage on the check
Hostile attitude	Disadvantage on the check
After a failure	Wait 24 hours

⚠ Common questions:

Who decides the state?

The DM.

What's the default DC?

15, or Intelligence if higher.

Which checks?

Deception, Intimidation, Performance, Persuasion, Animal Handling.

Effect of a Friendly attitude?

Advantage.

Effect of a Hostile attitude?

Disadvantage.

Can I retry?

Not for 24 hours, same approach.

⚠ Debate points and table options: Table rule

Lying

Can an NPC detect a lie? **Option**: an Insight check.

Intimidation

Does it make an NPC hostile? **Option**: yes after a failure.

Group

Several players speak. **Option**: one roll, the best.

⚠ Rule clarifications (answers found on the web, reworded):

Influence

It's an action, not a mere roll.

Animal Handling

It only works on Beasts and Monstrosities.

Waiting

A second attempt needs a cooldown.

These points remain open to discussion: your feedback is welcome to refine this sheet.

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